gooseberry and tender peppercorn masala, a tribute to tribal Kerala culture. The seafood moilee soup is made with local clams, scallops and prawns. And the city's mussels are roasted with shallots and spices to become Calicut Kallummakaya Fry.

South Indian micro-cuisines, too, have made a mark. Bengaluru's celebrated 100-year-old Mavalli Tiffin Rooms (MTR) brought Karnataka-style food to Bellevue, Washington in 2023. Chefs here are trained at the original restaurant in Lalbagh, Bengaluru. Everything, from the rava idli to masala dose to bisi bele bath, is a taste of home.

And missing that very *amma veetu samayal* (mom's home cooking) was why Revathi Manoharan co-founded Thalaiva's Indian Kitchen in Park Ridge, Illinois, with chef-husband Vinoth Raju in 2018. "We stay rooted in our family recipes. We introduced locals to banana leaf meals, Thalappakattu Goat Biryani, Chicken 65, Kothu Parotta, Mutton Kola Urundai and Kollu rasam. Our proudest creations are the Pasipayaru Kadayal and the Kollu rasam—both made with green gram. We source ingredients locally. We import native spices like stone-ground black pepper and sun-dried red chillies from Tamil Nadu," says Revathi.

The success of South Indian restaurants in the US will encourage others hoping to bring their cuisines to the country. This will be fuelled by more people willing to explore Indian regional cuisine. The Indian food landscape in the US is poised for stellar growth. ■

—Ruth Dsouza Prabhu

A Sky Full Of (Michelin) Stars

DUBAI'S TRÈSIND STUDIO, HELMED BY CHEF HIMANSHU SAINI, IS THE FIRST INDIAN RESTAURANT TO GET THREE MICHELIN STARS

When Trèsind opened its doors in 2014 in Dubai, opinions wavered between gimmick and gastronomy. With each passing year, the restaurant cemented itself firmly on the culinary map. It wasn't just drama on the plate but about reclaiming pride in a cuisine that had long been boxed into clichés. Four years later, Trèsind Studio launched as its more introspective sibling. Bold plating, molecular gastronomy techniques and reimagined regional flavours became its signature, making it a pioneer in elevating the perception of Indian food internationally.

And this May, it became the first Indian restaurant to receive three Michelin stars. While the weight of that sentence alone is staggering, those following this journey see it more as the natural finale of what Chef Himanshu Saini had been saying all along. "This journey began with a belief that Indian cuisine deserved to be seen not just as nostalgic comfort food, but as a dynamic and innovative force," he maintains. "We've challenged expectations and remained rooted in authenticity. The stars are a symbol of what passion, discipline and creative freedom can achieve. As Indian restaurants around the world shape the next chapter of our cuisine, we get to be part of this journey forward."

That belief has always run deep at Trèsind Studio,



HIGH TABLE Chef Himanshu Saini feels Indian food is now regarded as a global cuisine



FOR THE ONAM SADYA, EVERY STAFF MEMBER STEPS UP TO THE TABLE TO PLATE DIFFERENT ELEMENTS IN CHOREOGRAPHED UNISON

where food serves as emotion, memory and movement. The Onam Sadya course comes to mind, where every staff member steps up to the table to plate different elements in choreographed unison. You see it in the kitchen too, quiet discipline that's more like a dance than a dinner service. Reiterating the feeling, Chef Himanshu adds, "This honour belongs to my entire team, who pour their hearts into every plate, and every detail. Through our food, we tell stories of heritage and evolution."

"Indian food has found its place among the world's great cuisines," he says. "It's not just about global recognition, it's about taking pride in who we are and what we cook." If that's the case, then Trèsind Studio just carved out a place in history. From here on, the only way is up. ■

–Caroline D'Almeida